



Disciplined Desktops?

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Everybody needs a PC and everybody needs to upgrade to a new one every now and then. Most people would and should run down to their local computer shopping area and pick up some stuff, go home and assemble it. But then that isn't everybody's piece of cake. So automatically, the next best solution is to have somebody build a PC for you. That brings along additional worries of warranty and whether your computer will get fixed in time or not. Will you have to run after your computer-walla every few days asking him whether the replacement part has returned? The only solution sensible left then is to go in for a desktop PC from one of the well known PC manufacturers and there have been many over the past decade or so.

We were looking at desktop PCs. We've received a few desktops from the manu-

facturers we contact with a few specific models. These were going to be non-gaming desktops for those who want PCs for their SoHos and maybe some everyday home use.

Acer Aspire IE3222

The Acer Aspire IE3222 look suggests that it is a desktop geared for use at home. The Acer Aspire IE3222's cabinet is nowhere as compact as the other Acer – the NX4440 but is somewhat stylish. The front end has a raised section that houses four USB ports and the two audio connectors. A nice big flat power button is located at one corner.

The Interiors are extremely spacious and the few cables present are neatly tied up at the bottom of the case. A rear fan takes care of the cooling and ventilation. It isn't very noisy overall. It's a little weird to see a LPT port and a serial port on a PC today. Build quality of the cabinet is good and it has the sliding lock feature for all the drives.

An ECS i945 motherboard and an Intel Core 2 Duo E2220 power this system. This

combination along with 2GB of memory is good enough for basic office applications and browsing. We received a 16:9 aspect ratio 19-inch LCD screen for this PC like the other Acer desktops. The resolution isn't so great for vertical scrolling but nice for videos. The screen design is good and is an above-average performer. The keyboard and mouse combination are as expected – cheap but perfect for the job it's meant for.

The performance through all the tests weren't spectacular but it's a very evenly matched system. It makes a good system to upgrade from. For example, adding a cheap graphics card under Rs. 5,000 makes it a very good entry-level gaming system.

The IE3222 isn't such a great performer and is priced at Rs. 28,999. It is just a bit cheaper than the much more stylish and well designed NX4440 which we like. Although this system comes with a gigabyte more of memory, the NX4440 has a superior graphics solution. Even if you don't require the compact case that the NX4440 comes in, it is the more sensible buy.



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